8. Instagram, Website, Newsletter & Action Kit

The public side of the work: posts, reels, the website, the district's feature story and the Action Kit.

Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice

From screenshots taken October 8 and October 27, 2026.

- Account: SPASD Student Voice (@spasdstudentvoice)
- October 27: 39 posts · 29 followers · 13 following (October 8: 38 posts · 24 followers · 15 following). Also on Threads.
- Bio: "Amplifying student voice across SPASD. Focused on safety, communication & fairness. Turning feedback into action. Join the conversation ↓"
- Links: tinyurl.com/4ww4rkeh and one more
- Highlights: Spotlights, Posts
- Pinned posts: "Your Voice. Our Future. Help Shape SPASD!" (survey QR code), "Student Voice Check-In," "Students: Make Your Voice Heard! — Starting a student-led project to improve safety, fairness & communication across all SPASD schools!"

Accounts followed include: Sun Prairie Schools (@sunprairieschooldistrict), Sun Prairie West High Student Senate (@spweststudie, @spwstudentsenate), SPW Student Council (@spwstuco, @spweststuco), SPW Athletics Activities, Madison College and Madison College Ambassadors, Wisconsin Student Action (@wistudentaction), KeepStudentsConnectedWI, Empower (@empower.wi), WI Public Education Network (@wiscednetwork), Instagram, and Instagram's Creators.

Other posts visible on the grid include "We're back," a 9/11 remembrance post, and a Labor Day post.

Reels (October 2026)

- "You said, we did" (14 seconds): "Students never got the district newsletter. Not once. Only parents did." → "So we asked. At our October 20 meeting with district leaders." → "Confirmed in writing. October 21, 2026. Small change. Real proof that speaking up works." → "Every promise, tracked. spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app"
- Caregiver survey (20 seconds): "531 families weighed in. The district's caregiver survey, October 16–22." → "But when? That's where families split." → "Families with younger kids: 74% say start next year." → "Full analysis on the site."

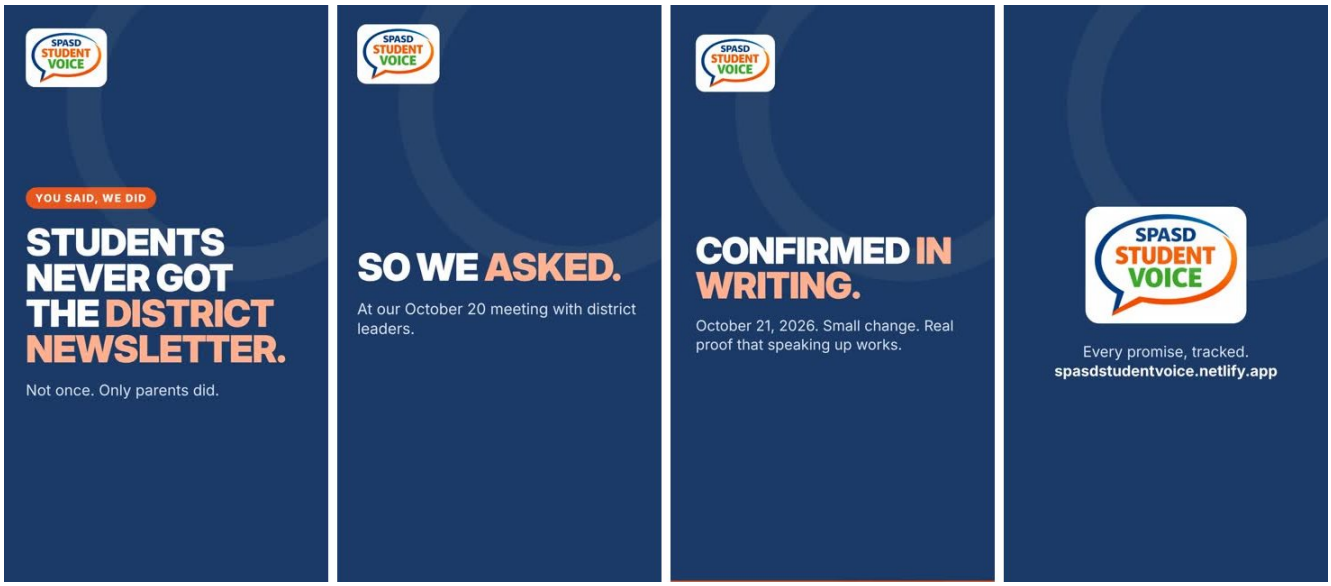
Posts and reels (October 29)

Four new feed graphics in the same navy, yellow and blue style, each ending with "Your voice. Your future. Our district."

- "Join Student Voice: We need every school." Calls for students from Sun Prairie East, Prairie Phoenix Academy, Patrick Marsh, Prairie View and Central Heights. "No experience needed. If you've ever asked 'why does school work like this?' you're in. DM us to join."
- "Fall 2026 update: You said. We did." Weighted grades: moving (to the Board Nov. 9, final vote expected late Nov.). Student newsletter: won (district committed in writing Oct. 21). Advisory council: asked (proposal sent to Dr. Reed). Ask the District: live (a new question every day).
- "Ask the District #1," a new daily series. Question: "When is the final Board vote on weighted grades, and which students would it apply to?" Status: sent to the district. "Answers get posted word for word. Got a question? Comment or DM us. Anonymous is fine."
- "2 minutes. Anonymous. This is your turn." Promotes the student survey on safety, clear info, fairness, and stress and support, in English or Español, at tinyurl.com/4ww4rkeh.

Five matching reels (about 16–19 seconds each):

- Ask the District (posted to @spasdstudentvoice Oct 29): one real question every day, sent to district leaders each Friday, answers posted word for word; Question #1 is waiting on an answer.
- This is your turn: the district hears adults all the time; tell them about safety, clear info, fairness, and stress and support; results go straight to district leaders plus the public report, with no names attached.
- Weighted grades go to the Board: harder classes can count more; timeline Nov. 2 Board committee preview, Nov. 9 full Board meeting with students present, final vote expected late November in time for course guides; shaped with students, who sat on the work group from the start; check the posted agenda to sign up for public comment.
- You said, we did: weighted grades moving, student newsletter won (first issue expected in November), advisory council asked (proposal sent to Superintendent Dr. Reed for a spring 2027 pilot), Ask the District live.
- We need every school: Sun Prairie East, Prairie Phoenix, middle schools, and you. "Ever asked 'why is it like this?' Then you're qualified." It takes 1–2 hours a month. Every school, every grade.



Reel: "You said, we did" newsletters (frames)



Reel: caregiver survey (frames)



Feed posts, October 29: Join, You said we did, Ask the District #1, This is your turn



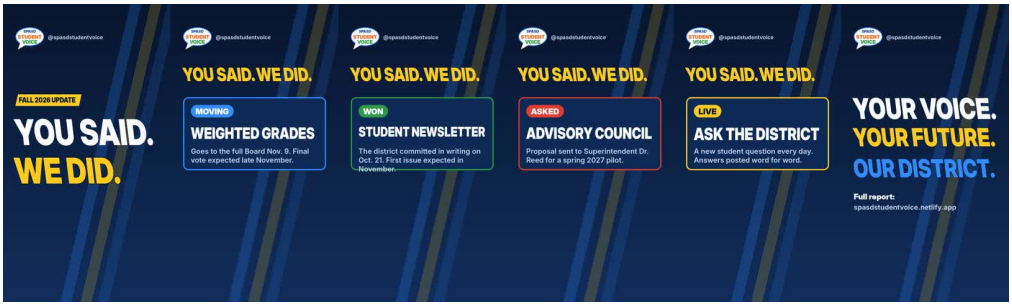
Reel: Ask the District (frames)



Reel: This is your turn (frames)



Reel: weighted grades go to the Board (frames)



Reel: You said, we did, fall update (frames)



Reel: we need every school (frames)

Ask the District Log

The daily "Ask the District" series on @spasdstudentvoice. Questions are sent to district leaders and answers are posted word for word.

#	Question	Status
1	When is the final Board vote on weighted grades, and which students would it apply to?	Sent to the district; waiting on an answer. (The district's own timeline says the final vote is expected late November.)

More questions will be added as they're posted.

Website: spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app

spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app — last updated October 22, 2026. Independent and student-led; not an official SPASD site.

Tabs: Home, Updates, You Said We Did, The Plan, Meeting Log, Reports, Emails, Archive, FAQ & Glossary, Sources, Contact, and a Spanish summary (En español).

- Updates: what's moving, what's stuck, and a timeline since January.
- You Said, We Did: a scoreboard of every promise to students: done, in progress, or waiting. First entry: district newsletters to every student, starting in November, confirmed in writing Oct 21.
- The Plan: the District Student Advisory Council proposal and the asks for October 20.
- Meeting Log: every meeting so far (22 with district, school and city leaders as of Oct 22).
- Reports: Report #4 and earlier progress reports, the budget explainer, weighted grades research, and the plate reader report.
- Emails: letters to district leaders and their replies, word for word (11 threads).
- Archive: this record, one part at a time.
- FAQ & Glossary, Sources, and Contact (district contacts plus a message form).

"Right now" on the home page: the advisory council (first on the list for the follow-up meeting), newsletters to every student (committed), a wider student survey (in progress), weighted grades (Board committee Nov 2, Board Nov 9, final vote late November), the student-rights guide (next step), and mandated-reporting information (still waiting since March 2).

District Newsletter Feature: Making a Difference Through Student Voice (Nov 3, 2026)

Photo from the district's story.



Zackary Mark, from the SPASD feature

From the Sun Prairie Area School District website (sunprairieschools.org), Nov 3, 2026. Copied word for word, except two words about grade level shown in [brackets].

Helping Others Find Their Voice: Zackary Mark's Commitment to Student Advocacy

Student advocacy doesn't always begin with a big idea or meeting with District leaders. For Sun Prairie West High School [student] Zackary Mark, sometimes it starts with finding the courage to do something as simple as sending an email.

Finding the courage to speak up didn't happen overnight for Zackary.

"When I first started this, I didn't have that confidence," Zackary said. "I've grown that, but you have to be able to send an email. Like, that's basic stuff, and then you gradually go from there."

Outside of school, Zackary has spent the past 10 years practicing karate, a hobby that takes up nearly every afternoon. But when he's not training, his remaining time goes toward student advocacy.

He follows District developments, writes about publicly available information, and shares updates and answers questions through his own online platforms.

What drives Zackary work and his passion for advocacy is helping students understand not only what decisions are being made, but why they're being made and how those decisions

affect them.

One idea Zackary has shared to improve communication was "You Said, We Did."

This helps students see how the District follows through on commitments, connecting what leaders say they will do with the actions taken afterward.

"The district said this, that they're gonna do this. Now here's the evidence that they did this," Zackary explained.

For him, it's about building trust.

That same interest in helping students understand District decisions has led Zackary to become involved in conversations about weighted GPA.

Currently, Sun Prairie uses an unweighted 4.0 GPA scale, meaning courses are calculated on the same scale regardless of their level of difficulty. A weighted GPA system would recognize the additional academic demands of more challenging courses, such as Advanced Placement classes. Zackary is one of the students involved in discussions about a proposal to transition to a weighted GPA system; if passed, it would begin with the Class of 2031.

As a [graduating student], Zackary would not benefit from the proposed change, but he believes it's important to consider how the transition would affect students who have already planned their high school courses under the current system.

"The easiest way for me to explain this is that I would love to have a weighted GPA," he shared. "That would look amazing for my transcript for colleges."

While Zackary has collaborated with others on projects such as weighted GPA and Act 95, he often researches, writes, and follows up on issues on his own.

Still, he wishes more students could be part of those conversations.

"I'd love to have a lot more student input and a lot more voice into the decisions that I do," he said.

But Zackary knows speaking up isn't always easy.

For students who may feel uncomfortable reaching out to school or District leaders, Zackary has a simple piece of advice.

"Confidence. Confidence is key."

He encourages students to start with what feels manageable, whether that's writing an email, making a phone call, or eventually attending a meeting.

"You want to start at your comfort level, what will work best for you, and gradually build up those skills because confidence is what you really need, and that doesn't just appear out of nowhere."

After graduation, Zackary hopes to attend either the University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee or the University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, pursuing studies in secondary education, social studies, and political science, along with a minor in Spanish.

His first goal is to become a high school social studies teacher. Eventually, he hopes to pursue a career in law, government, and education policy, where he can continue working toward change on a larger scale.

Zackary hopes the work he is doing will continue to allow more opportunities for students to ask questions and be heard.

"Those two things are really what it's all about; what all I'm doing is about." He shared.

For Zackary, it all comes back to the confidence to speak up, and that's what continues to drive his passion for student advocacy.

Student Voice Action Kit (October 2026)

A 14-page kit Zackary put together after the October 20 meeting and the caregiver survey, also posted on the SPASD Student Voice website. The caregiver survey findings in the kit are already in Part 3, so they aren't repeated here.

Weighted Grades: What Families Need to Know (student draft for the work group)

A short explainer drafted by a student member of the SPASD weighted grades work group, October 2026. This is a recommendation. The School Board makes the final decision.

What's changing: right now, SPASD uses an unweighted 4.0 GPA, so an A counts the same in every class. The work group is recommending a 5.0 scale for the most challenging classes. In a weighted class, an A would count as 5.0 instead of 4.0.

Which classes would be weighted (5.0 scale):

- AP courses
- Capstone classes, including try-out music courses
- Classes that earn college credit or an industry certification

Not weighted:

- College-credit or certification classes that match a class the high school already offers
- Classes that don't transfer for credit to UW colleges and universities

Counselors are reviewing the Madison College class list now. Every weighted class will be marked in the course guide so students know before they choose.

Who it applies to: the recommendation is to start with students entering 9th grade in fall 2027 (the Class of 2031) and add a grade each year after that.

Why not current students? Current high schoolers chose their classes under the old rules. Changing the rules partway through would reward some choices after the fact and not others, and it would change class rank for students who are already being ranked. Starting with a new class means every student in it knows the rules before choosing a single course.

Open question for the work group: 69% of caregivers of current high schoolers asked for it to apply now. One option to consider is weighting classes taken from 2027–28 onward for every student, without recalculating past grades.

Questions families asked:

- Does it apply to my student? Under the recommendation, only to students starting 9th grade in fall 2027 or later.
- Will past grades be recalculated? No. Grades already earned stay as they are.
- How does it connect to Act 95 and college? Act 95 guarantees admission to Universities of Wisconsin schools for students in the top 10% of their class (top 5% for UW–Madison), so class rank matters. Many colleges also recalculate GPAs their own way. [District to confirm how weighted GPA will be used for class rank and shown on transcripts.]

- Is it fair to students who can't take AP? Weighted classes have to be open to every student who meets the prerequisites. [District to add how students get support to access these classes.]
- How can I give input? The plan goes to the Board's Teaching & Learning Committee on November 2 (4:45 PM, District Service Center) and the full Board on November 9. Both meetings are open to the public.

Based on the work group's October 15 and 20 recommendations and the caregiver survey (531 responses, October 16–22, 2026). Items in brackets need district confirmation before this is shared with families. Spanish version to follow.

Weighted Grades Board Kit (November 2 and 9, 2026)

Before you go:

- Nov 2, 4:45 PM: Teaching & Learning Committee preview, District Service Center. Small table, two Board members. Best chance for a real conversation.
- Nov 9: full Board of Education. Check the posted agenda for how to sign up for public comment, usually before the meeting starts. Comments are often limited to 2–3 minutes.
- Bring printed copies of the one-page summary for Board members.

Public comment script (about 2 minutes):

> Good evening, President McFarland and members of the Board. My name is Zackary Mark. I'm a student in the district and a member of the weighted grades work group.
>
> In January, 31 students came to this Board to talk about Act 95. Since then, students have worked alongside district staff to build the plan you're seeing tonight, and I want to share three numbers.
>
> First, 78%. That's the share of students in last year's Act 95 survey who chose some kind of weighted GPA.
>
> Second, 70%. That's how many of the 531 parents and caregivers who answered this month support weighted grades, and it's almost the same at West and East.
>
> Third, 69%. That's how many caregivers of current high schoolers want this to apply to their students now. Our plan starts with next year's freshmen, for good reasons, but those families deserve a clear answer about why, and I'd ask the Board to make sure that answer is part of how this is shared.
>
> This plan rewards students for challenging themselves, and it was built with students at the table. I hope you'll support it, and I hope this is how more decisions get made in our district. Thank you.

Statement to be read for him if he can't attend:

> Members of the Board, I'm sorry I can't be here tonight; I'm at work. I'm a student on the weighted grades work group. Students asked for a fairer way to recognize challenging classes, and this plan does that. Students supported a weighted option in last year's Act 95 survey (78%), and 70% of caregivers support it this month. I'd ask one thing: that the district clearly explain to current high school families why the plan starts with next year's freshmen, since 69% of them hoped it would apply now. Thank you for including students in this decision. — Zackary Mark

Talking points for the Nov 2 committee preview:

- Lead with the reason: the recommendation is built on rigor, and rigor was also caregivers' top factor (75%).
- Name the timing split before a Board member hears it from a parent.
- Ask how weighted GPA will be used for class rank under Act 95. Families asked this more than anything except timing.
- Ask what support exists so every student can access weighted classes. That's opponents' strongest point.
- Offer students' help with the written explanation, since 72% of caregivers asked for one.

One-page handout for Board members: What Students and Families Said

- Act 95 student survey (Dec 2025 – Jan 2026), 903 students: 78% of students who picked a ranking option chose a weighted GPA. 55% barely knew about Act 95 beforehand.
- Caregiver survey (Oct 16–22, 2026), 531 caregivers: 70% support weighted grades. West 68%, East 73%.
- Caregiver survey, timing (462 answered): current high school families 69% apply now; families with only younger kids 74% start next year.
- Caregiver survey, classes: 85% want AP weighted. Top factor: rigor (75%).
- Caregiver survey, communication: 72% want a detailed written explanation.

What families want answered: Does it apply to my student? How does it affect Act 95 and college admissions? Which classes count? Is it fair to students without access? Is the decision already made?

Students' ask: approve the plan, and share it with a clear written explanation that answers current families directly. Both surveys were self-selected.

District Student Advisory Council: Pilot Plan (for Dr. Reed, Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue)

A spring 2027 pilot that can answer the shared goal from October 20: by June 2027, students can name something that changed because they spoke up.

The idea in one sentence: a small group of students from every SPASD middle and high school meets with district leaders on a regular schedule, brings what students are saying, and hears back what happened to it.

- Who: 3–5 students from each middle and high school (about 25–30 total), across grades, and reflecting each school's racial, gender and program mix. This follows Dr. Reed's August suggestion.
- How students join: a short application open to every student (in English and Spanish), plus one seat per school saved for a student recommended by a counselor or teacher, to reach students who don't usually apply.
- Staff partner: one district leader who owns the council, plus a staff contact at each school. This is the first thing needed.

- Meetings: four in the pilot (January, February, April and May 2027), 60 minutes, during the school day or right after, with a virtual option for middle schoolers.
- Agenda: each meeting has one district topic leaders want student input on, one topic students bring, and updates on earlier input.
- Closing the loop: within 30 days of each meeting, the district shares a short "You said, we did" update: what changed, what's in progress, and what can't happen and why.
- Families: a parent team alongside, as Dr. Reed suggested, meeting twice during the pilot.
- Cost: mostly staff time. Possibly snacks, printing and transportation for after-school meetings.

Timeline: November 2026 — name a staff partner and agree on the pilot plan · December 2026 — applications open at every school; wider student survey runs · January 2027 — members selected; first meeting on survey results and priorities · February–May 2027 — three more meetings, each followed by a "You said, we did" update · June 2027 — review the pilot with students, staff and the Board and decide whether to make it permanent.

How we'll know it worked:

- Every middle and high school was represented at every meeting.
- At least three "You said, we did" updates were published.
- Students on the council can name at least one change that came from their input.
- In a June survey, more students say they know where to bring an idea than in December.

The ask: name a staff partner by the end of November so applications can open in December.

Outreach & Growth Plan (November–December 2026)

Goal: get beyond the same small group. Reach every high school, every grade, and students who don't usually speak up, which is what Dr. Morgan asked for on October 20.

Where things stand: 39 Instagram posts and 29 followers, also on Threads; a website that installs as a phone app; a bilingual survey. The reach is still mostly one school and one friend group.

Channels, ranked by reach:

1. District student newsletter (starts November): survey link and blurb in the first issue — Ms. Bevenue (email drafted), by Nov 6
2. SP30 at both high schools: teachers show the survey QR code once — Zack (email drafted), by Nov 13
3. Student Council and Student Senate (West and East): repost the survey and the newsletter win — Zack, by Nov 6
4. Flyers: get approval, then post at both high schools, the library and Kicks Unlimited — Zack, by Nov 13
5. East High students: recruit 2–3 co-leads from East — Zack, by Nov 20
6. Spanish-speaking families: share Spanish posts with ELL teachers and family liaisons — Zack, by Nov 20
7. Middle schools: ask middle school principals to share the survey with 8th graders — Zack, in December after the council pilot is approved

Messages to send:

> DM to Student Council and Student Senate: Hey! I run @spasdstudentvoice. Last week the district confirmed students will start getting the district newsletter in November because we asked for it. We're trying to get the student survey to every grade so district leaders hear from more than a few of us. Would you be willing to repost it to your story? Link's in our bio. Thank you!
>
> DM to students at East: Hey, I'm Zack. I've been working with district leaders on student voice stuff, like weighted grades and getting students the district newsletter. Right now it's way too West-heavy and I want East to have an equal say. Would you be down to help lead it with me? It's mostly sharing what students at East care about and coming to a meeting or two. No experience needed.

Posting calendar: week of Oct 26 — "You said, we did": newsletters (English + Spanish slides), Reel version · Nov 2 — caregiver survey carousel and Reel; story reminder for the Board committee · Nov 9 — story reminder for the Board meeting; recap post after · Nov 16 — district story with the interview (if published); survey push · Nov 23 — weighted grades final vote result; Thanksgiving post · Nov 30 — November monthly update · Dec 7 — advisory council applications (if approved); survey last call.

What to measure: survey responses by school and grade (goal: at least 25 for every high school and grade); followers (goal: 100 by winter break); messages through the site's form; new co-leads (goal: 3, including at least one from East).

Wider Student Survey: What Good Student Voice Looks Like

The first step toward the June 2027 goal: ask students across the district what student voice working well looks and sounds like, then set goals from their answers. Planned in response to Dr. Morgan's October 20 feedback.

Who we need to hear from:

- Sun Prairie West, grades 9–12: 25+ per grade, through SP30, Student Senate and the newsletter
- Sun Prairie East, grades 9–12: 25+ per grade, through SP30, East co-leads and the newsletter
- Prairie Phoenix Academy and Sun Prairie Virtual: as many as possible, through a staff contact at each
- Middle schools (grade 8): a pilot with one or two schools, principal-approved, short version
- Spanish-speaking students: included in every group, with a Spanish version and ELL teachers

Optional questions on school, grade, and how students describe their identity will check whether the people who answered match the district, and gaps will be reported honestly.

Draft questions (5 minutes):

1. Which school and grade are you in?
2. Do you know where to bring an idea or concern at school? (Yes / Not sure / No)
3. In the last year, did you ever see something change because students asked for it? If yes, what?

4. When something serious happens at school, how do you usually find out? (District/school message, teacher, friends, social media, news, I don't)
5. Rate: "Adults in my school listen to students' ideas." (1–5)
6. What would student voice working well look or sound like at your school? (open)
7. Which matter most to you right now? (pick up to 3: safety, mental health, grades and class rank, schedules, lunch, communication, fairness in discipline, clubs and activities, other)
8. How would you want to hear back about student input? (newsletter, Instagram, in class, website, email)
9. Would you want to be part of a student advisory council? (Yes / Maybe / No)
10. Anything else district leaders should know? (open)

Timeline: November 2026 — share draft questions with Dr. Morgan, translate, get approval to share through district channels · December 1–18, 2026 — survey open, with weekly checks on who has answered · January 2027 — public, anonymous results report and three to five goals with benchmarks, shared with the advisory council at its first meeting · May 2027 — short follow-up survey for the June 2027 check-in.

Privacy: anonymous by default, with no names or student IDs; results shared only as summaries, and quotes only when they can't identify anyone; any serious safety concern a student writes about is passed to district staff, and the survey says so up front.

How to Start Student Voice at Your School (a guide for any student)

1. Start with one clear letter. Write to your principal or School Board about one thing students are worried about. Say what happened, how it affects students, and two or three specific, doable asks. Keep it respectful. You're asking to be part of the solution, not blaming anyone.
2. Ask for a meeting, then write it down. Ask for 30 minutes. Bring a one-page handout. Take notes, and ask before recording. Within two days, email a short recap ("so we all leave with the same notes"). That recap is what turns a nice conversation into a commitment.
3. Get real input, not just your friends'. Run a short anonymous survey in every language families speak. Share it through teachers and newsletters, not only social media. Report who answered, including who's missing.
4. Keep a public record. Post short updates: what you asked, what you were told, what changed. A free website and an Instagram account are enough. Give district leaders a chance to correct anything before you post it, and set a deadline.
5. Track promises. Keep a "You said, we did" list. Every commitment gets an owner, a date and a status. Celebrate wins publicly; it's the best proof that speaking up works.
6. Join the groups that already exist. Work groups, Student Senate and Board student sessions are where decisions get made. Ask to join them before starting something new.
7. Protect people. Don't post names of students, private phone numbers, or rumors about staff. Stick to facts from public records and the news. If someone tells you they're unsafe, help them reach a trusted adult right away.
8. Make it last after you graduate. Recruit co-leads from different grades and schools early. Share passwords and files with them. Push for something permanent, like an advisory

council, so student voice doesn't depend on one person.

Handoff plan for SPASD Student Voice: recruit 3 co-leads by December 2026, including one from East and one underclassman; share the Instagram, website and records with them by March 2027; co-leads run the April and May updates; full handoff by June 2027.

"You Said, We Did": Semester Update (template for the district)

A suggested one-page format the district could publish twice a year (January and June), so every student can see what happened to their input. Suggested by students in the October 20, 2026 meeting with Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue.

- Opening (2–3 sentences): This semester, students shared ideas through [surveys, the student advisory council, Student Senate, meetings]. Here's what we heard and what happened.
- What changed: "Students never got the district newsletter" → newsletters now go to students as well as families (November 2026). "Harder classes should count more toward GPA" → [weighted grades decision, if approved]. [Student input] → [Action] → [Date].
- In progress: "Students want to know when outside agencies get involved and when parents are told" → [student rights guide in progress], next update [date].
- What we can't do, and why: [student input] — [plain reason, naming the law when one applies] — [what we can do instead].
- How to share an idea: [where students bring ideas: the advisory council rep at your school, the student survey, your principal, or a form]. Students should hear back within 30 days.

Tips: keep it to one page, write it for a 9th grader, publish it in the student newsletter and on the district website, and translate it into Spanish.

Student Voice Flyer



SPASD Student Voice flyer, October 2026